

D721

Student Teaching I in Secondary Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

In a ninth-grade algebra class that meets in a room with new desks, students can solve $3x + 5 = 20$ but cannot explain why the same steps work for $ax + b = c$. The class has 30 students and a strong math team. What should the student teacher do?

- A. Solve several number examples side by side and have students describe the pattern before writing the general steps.
- B. Ask the math team students to explain it to others.
- C. Teach the general form only, since ninth graders think abstractly.
- D. Drill more number equations with no link to the rule.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A chemistry student teacher explains the particle model of gases with only equations, and students are lost. Which change applies the same principle?

- A. Speed up so students hear it more times.
- B. Skip the model; it is too hard.
- C. Show a simulation or physical model of particles moving before the equations.
- D. Add more equations.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A student teacher in an eleventh-grade English class suspects some essays were written by an AI tool. The school has no written policy, and the essays are on a novel set in a small fishing town. What is the best step going forward?

- A. Ban all technology forever.
- B. Give zeros based on an AI detector score.
- C. Work with the mentor to set and teach a clear AI policy and require drafts or in-class writing that show process.
- D. Change to a novel not set in a fishing town.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A tenth grader earned 85, 90, 88, and a 0 for a missing lab. The student's older brother graduated last year, and the lab was on plant cells. What is her average, and what does it suggest?

- A. 65.75, which hides that her completed work averaged about 88.
- B. 87.67
- C. 65.75, which shows her true mastery.
- D. 88

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

On a 100-point scale where a D is 60, a teacher wants to know how many points a zero is below the lowest D. How far below is it, compared with the 10-point width of each other letter band?

- A. 6 points.
- B. 50 points.
- C. 60 points below — six times the size of a single letter band.
- D. 10 points, like other bands.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

In a tenth-grade biology class, several students newly arrived from other countries talk through a lab in Spanish before writing their English lab reports. The lab uses new microscopes, and the room is on the second floor. How should the student teacher respond?

- A. Require English only so they learn faster.
- B. Allow the Spanish discussion and support the move to academic English in the written report.
- C. Seat them far from the microscopes.
- D. Let them write the reports only in Spanish all year.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A student teacher is starting a new semester with a twelfth-grade government class. The school just painted the halls, and the class has many athletes. Her mentor's old list has fifteen rules starting with "Don't." What approach best builds a positive environment?

- A. Make no norms, since seniors are adults.
- B. Post the fifteen don't rules.
- C. Make special rules for athletes.
- D. Build a short set of positively stated norms with the class and practice them.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

During a 50-minute lesson, the observer recorded 40 minutes of teacher talk. The student teacher coaches volleyball, and the lesson was on the Constitution. What percentage of the lesson was teacher talk, and what is a useful goal?

- A. 80%; set a goal to lower it, for example by adding structured student discussion.
- B. 40%; no change needed.
- C. 20%; the students talked most.
- D. 80%, which is fine because content is hard.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student teacher wants teacher talk to be no more than 40% of a 55-minute lesson. What is the most teacher talk she can plan?

- A. 15 minutes
- B. 33 minutes
- C. 40 minutes
- D. 22 minutes

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A student teacher assigns online homework in a class where nearly every student has a phone. Six students rarely complete it; the class also has a busy lunch schedule. What should the student teacher check first?

- A. Assume phones are enough for all homework.
- B. Whether those students have home internet and a suitable device, and offer offline or in-school options.
- C. Assume they are lazy and lower their grades.
- D. Move lunch so students have more time.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A school survey finds that 5 of 30 students lack home internet. What percent of the class would be shut out by online-only homework?

- A. About 83%
- B. About 17%
- C. 5%
- D. 6%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A student teacher disagrees with how the cooperating teacher grades late work. The cooperating teacher has run the department for years, and the school has a new principal. What is the best first step?

- A. Email the new principal.
- B. Change the grades without asking.
- C. Complain to other student teachers.
- D. Ask the cooperating teacher privately to discuss the grading approach.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

In a ninth-grade algebra class ~~that meets in a room with new desks~~, students can solve $3x + 5 = 20$ but cannot explain why the same steps work for $ax + b = c$. ~~The class has 30 students and a strong math team.~~ What should the student teacher do?

Target word: bridge to the abstract **Decides:** Students handle the concrete case, not the general form.

A	Correct	Worked concrete examples lead to the abstract rule.
B	Camouflage	Answers the math team detail.
C	Absolute language	Abstract reasoning is still developing.
D	Dropped element	Drops the step connecting to the general form.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A chemistry student teacher explains the particle model of gases with only equations, and students are lost. Which change applies the same principle?

Target word: apply to a new subject **Decides:** Add concrete representation.

A	Dropped element	Repetition without a concrete bridge does not help.
B	Adjacent category	Removes the content instead of scaffolding it.
C	Correct	Concrete visuals support abstract ideas.
D	Inverted operation	Increases abstraction.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A student teacher in an eleventh-grade English class suspects some essays were written by an AI tool. The school has no written policy, ~~and the essays are on a novel set in a small fishing town.~~ What is the best step going forward?

Target word: AI integrity response **Decides:** No clear policy; task design matters.

A	Absolute language	Too broad; the need is a clear policy and design.
B	Adjacent category	Detectors are unreliable; no policy was set.
C	Correct	Clear expectations plus process evidence support integrity.
D	Camouflage	Answers the setting detail.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A tenth grader earned 85, 90, 88, and a 0 for a missing lab. ~~The student's older brother graduated last year, and the lab was on plant cells.~~ What is her average, and what does it suggest?

Target word: average with a zero **Decides:** $(85 + 90 + 88 + 0) / 4$.

A	Correct	$263 / 4 = 65.75$; one zero drags a high-B record to a failing-range grade.
B	Dropped element	Drops the zero from the average.
C	Inverted operation	The zero measures a missing task, not mastery.
D	Wrong stem number	A single score, not the average.

5. Answer C Concept 3 · transfer

On a 100-point scale where a D is 60, a teacher wants to know how many points a zero is below the lowest D. How far below is it, compared with the 10-point width of each other letter band?

Target word: compare scale gap **Decides:** 0 vs. 60.

A	Wrong stem number	The ratio, not the point gap.
B	Dropped element	Uses 50 as the D cutoff, not 60.
C	Correct	$60 - 0 = 60$ points; $60 \div 10 = 6$ band widths.
D	Absolute language	The F range is 0–59, not 10 points wide.

6. Answer B Concept 4

In a tenth-grade biology class, several students newly arrived from other countries talk through a lab in Spanish before writing their English lab reports. ~~The lab uses new microscopes, and the room is on the second floor.~~ How should the student teacher respond?

Target word: home language in class **Decides:** Home language is a resource for thinking.

A	Inverted operation	Blocks a resource for learning content.
B	Correct	Using home language builds understanding and bridges to English.
C	Camouflage	Answers the equipment detail.
D	Absolute language	Still needs to build academic English.

7. Answer D Concept 5

A student teacher is starting a new semester with a twelfth-grade government class. ~~The school just painted the halls, and the class has many athletes.~~ Her mentor's old list has fifteen rules starting with "Don't." What approach best builds a positive environment?

Target word: setting norms **Decides:** Co-constructed positive norms.

A	Dropped element	Drops expectations altogether.
B	Inverted operation	Negative, teacher-only rules.
C	Camouflage	Answers the athlete detail.
D	Correct	Student ownership and positive wording increase follow-through.

8. Answer A Concept 6

During a 50-minute lesson, the observer recorded 40 minutes of teacher talk. ~~The student teacher coaches volleyball, and the lesson was on the Constitution.~~ What percentage of the lesson was teacher talk, and what is a useful goal?

Target word: talk-time percent **Decides:** 40 / 50.

A	Correct	$40 \div 50 = 0.80$.
B	Wrong stem number	Uses the minutes as a percent.
C	Inverted operation	That is the student share.
D	Adjacent category	Explains the number away instead of using it.

9. Answer D Concept 6 · transfer

A student teacher wants teacher talk to be no more than 40% of a 55-minute lesson. What is the most teacher talk she can plan?

Target word: solve for minutes **Decides:** 0.40×55 .

A	Dropped element	Subtracts 40 from 55 instead of multiplying.
B	Inverted operation	That is the student share (60%).
C	Wrong stem number	Treats 40% as 40 minutes.
D	Correct	$0.40 \times 55 = 22$.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A student teacher assigns online homework in a class where nearly every student has a phone. Six students rarely complete it; ~~the class also has a busy lunch schedule~~. What should the student teacher check first?

Target word: cause of low completion **Decides:** Phones do not mean internet or devices for schoolwork.

A	Absolute language	Phones may lack data or suitable apps.
B	Correct	Access must be confirmed before assigning online work.
C	Adjacent category	Jumps to motivation without checking access.
D	Camouflage	Answers the lunch detail.

11. Answer B Concept 7 · transfer

A school survey finds that 5 of 30 students lack home internet. What percent of the class would be shut out by online-only homework?

Target word: compute share **Decides:** $5 / 30$.

A	Inverted operation	That is the share with internet.
B	Correct	$5 \div 30 \approx 0.167$.
C	Wrong stem number	The count, not the percent.
D	Dropped element	Divides 30 by 5 and treats it as a percent.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A student teacher disagrees with how the cooperating teacher grades late work. The cooperating teacher has run the department for years, and ~~the school has a new principal~~. What is the best first step?

Target word: handling a disagreement **Decides:** Talk directly and privately first.

A	Camouflage	Answers the principal detail and skips the colleague.
B	Inverted operation	Acts against the mentor instead of talking.
C	Adjacent category	Gossip is not professional communication.
D	Correct	Direct, private conversation comes first.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	7	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	5	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	5	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	0	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Scaffolding abstract reasoning	Adolescents are still developing abstract reasoning; concrete examples, worked examples, and visuals help them reach abstract ideas.	Assuming all teens can handle purely abstract instruction because of their age.	Students who can do the example but not the general rule.
2	Academic integrity with AI tools	Set a clear policy on when AI tools are allowed, teach it, and design tasks that show process (drafts, reflections, in-class work).	Banning or allowing everything with no clear guidance, or relying only on AI detectors.	Suspicion that student writing was generated by a tool.
3	The effect of zeros on a 100-point scale	A single zero pulls an average down far more than any other failing grade, so it can hide what a student actually learned.	Believing a zero is just another low grade.	Averages with one zero among other scores.
4	Culturally sustaining use of home languages	Treat students' home languages and dialects as resources, allowing them for thinking and discussion while building academic English.	Banning home languages in class to speed up English learning.	Multilingual students in a content class.
5	Co-constructed classroom norms	Norms built with students, stated positively, and practiced are more owned and followed than teacher-imposed rule lists.	Believing a long list of don'ts creates a positive climate.	Setting up a new class's expectations.
6	Using observation data on teacher talk	Talk-time data (teacher vs. student) turn feedback into a measurable goal for the next lesson.	Dismissing observation data as a judgment rather than evidence.	A percentage of class time spent on teacher talk.
7	Digital equity	Before assigning online homework, check students' access to devices and internet and provide offline or in-school options.	Assuming every teen has home internet because they have phones.	An online assignment with low completion from certain students.
8	Professional communication with colleagues	Raise a concern with the colleague directly and privately first, then follow the school's chain of command if needed.	Complaining to others or going straight to the principal.	A disagreement with a colleague or mentor.

Course scope (public description): Student Teaching I is the first part of a two-part series and is a mandatory course for all candidates seeking initial licensure. This course provides a supervised classroom experience in a real-world setting, allowing candidates to demonstrate and reflect upon professional ethics and dispositions, collaborate with experienced teachers, and implement instructional strategies rooted in students' learning and developmental patterns. Building on the responsibilities and skills developed in Advanced Clinical, candidates will receive ongoing feedback through observations and evaluations. Feedback will encourage candidates to reflect on their commitment to professional practices as educators, analyze and adjust teaching methods, and explore new teaching materials and methods that are culturally relevant. Additionally, the course features synchronous learning sessions that delve into communication and collaboration, accepting feedback, creating positive learning environments, and technology and online learning. Candidates must attend the required synchronous learning sessions in addition to their classroom placement.